MONTHLY UPDATE

Liberia: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-3 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies · Legislation and regulation · Data protection · Regional collaboration · Standards · Public debate and participation in policymaking

Strategies, plans and policies

NATIONAL FINANCIAL INCLUSION AND EDUCATION STRATEGY 2026-2030

- **Liberia: CBL's New Financial Inclusion Plan Hinges on ID, Business Registry Reforms** — FrontPage Africa, 16 September 2026

  Liberia's draft national financial inclusion and education strategy went through a two-day validation and will be revised. Participants said its success depends on the identity registry, business registration and credit reference systems, and parts will need legislation and budget.

Legislation and regulation

DRAFT INFRASTRUCTURE REGULATIONS

- **LTA Holds Public Consultation on Draft Infrastructure Regulations** — Liberian Observer, 12 October 2026

  Liberia's telecommunications authority consulted internet service providers, mobile operators and licensees on draft regulations for deploying, sharing, managing and decommissioning telecoms infrastructure. The draft text is not held.

Data protection

DISCLOSURE OF SOCIAL PROTECTION BENEFICIARY RECORDS

- **CDC Youth League Accuses LWSC Boss, Gender Minister of Exposing Vulnerable Children's Data, Demands Probe** — The People News Online, 12 September 2026

  Liberia's opposition CDC youth league demanded an investigation into Liberia Water and Sewer Corporation head Mohammed Ali and gender minister Gbeme Horace-Kollie. Its statement of 12 September 2026 alleges Ali posted on Facebook a spreadsheet of names, addresses, ages and schools of child abuse and neglect survivors, supplied by the minister. The allegations are the league's.

- **MGCSP Admits Authentic Beneficiary Data Leaked, Launches Internal Investigation** — Smart News Liberia, 14 September 2026

Liberia's Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection confirmed on 13 September 2026 that beneficiary records from its Save the Future Project circulating on social media are authentic and were never authorised for release, and opened an internal investigation. The records concern children removed from street situations; the ministry rejected claims they list survivors of gender-based violence and said it had shared collated data with funding partners.

Regional collaboration

STUDY VISIT TO THE RWANDAN E-GOVERNMENT MODEL

- **E-gouvernance : Gabon, Guinée, Liberia… le Rwanda attire les administrations africaines venues étudier son modèle numérique** — Digital Business Africa, 1 September 2026 RWANDA GABON GUINEA

  Rwanda Cooperation said it hosted eight government delegations from seven countries in one week in late August 2026: Liberia, Kenya, Nigeria, Benin, Gambia, Gabon and Guinea. A delegation from Gabon's interior ministry spent nearly two weeks studying e-government, AI policy, digital civil registration and identification, cybersecurity, data protection and system interconnection.

REVENUE AUTHORITY ASSISTANCE TO THE GAMBIA ON A REVENUE COLLECTION DASHBOARD

- **GRA and Liberia Revenue Authority sign deal to deepen digital cooperation** — The Point, 21 September 2026 GAMBIA

  The Gambian account of the Liberia–Gambia revenue dashboard agreement, summarised under the GNN Liberia report. It adds that the LRA pays the expert's airfare while the GRA covers lodging and local transport.

- **LRA to Provide Technical Support for Gambia's Revenue Collection Dashboard** — Global News Network Liberia, 21 September 2026 GAMBIA

  The Liberia Revenue Authority signed a memorandum of engagement to help the Gambia Revenue Authority build a dashboard that tracks revenue collection; it was announced from Accra on 20 September 2026 and signed during meetings of the West African Tax Administration Forum. The help covers a review of GRA's data sources, choice of indicators, design, a prototype, integration and staff training. The LRA will send the developer of its own dashboard to Banjul for an initial three weeks.

CENTRAL BANK MEMORANDUM WITH THE BANK OF GHANA ON PAYMENT SYSTEMS

- **Bank of Ghana and Liberia central bank strengthen partnership on payment systems** — Ghana Guardian, 3 October 2026 GHANA

  A Central Bank of Liberia delegation led by Executive Governor Henry Saamoi visited the Bank of Ghana in Accra on 1 October 2026 to learn how Ghana set up its interbank payment and settlement system, GhIPSS, to inform Liberia's own payment-systems work. The visit falls under a capacity-building memorandum the two central banks signed earlier in 2026.

- **Liberia Studies Ghana's Payment Switch as It Expands Instant Transfers** — NewsGhana, 4 October 2026 GHANA

  The governor of the Central Bank of Liberia led a delegation to the Bank of Ghana on 1 October to study how Ghana set up its interbank payment and settlement company. Liberia is working to connect its banks to the instant payment system it switched on in December 2025.

Standards

STATUTORY SCHOOL RECORD-KEEPING BOOKLET

- **Liberia: Ministry Moves to Standardize School Records Nationwide** — Ministry of Education, Liberia (via APO Group), 13 September 2026

  Liberia's Ministry of Education opened a five-day session in Kakata to develop and validate a Statutory School Record-Keeping Booklet, one nationwide system for school records on students, teachers, attendance and infrastructure. County teams are then to finalise education operational plans from the 2024/25 school census fact sheets.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

DISCLOSURE OF TELECOMMUNICATIONS SECTOR REVENUE

- **Liberia: LTA Embarrasses Boakai** — allAfrica.com (The New Republic Liberia), 3 September 2026

  The New Republic reported on 3 September 2026 that Liberia's President Joseph Boakai summoned the Telecommunications Authority's acting chairperson, Clarence Massaquoi, to the Executive Mansion over undisclosed revenue activities. Civil society and the media have sought disclosure of sector revenue for months. Commissioners can be removed only for established cause; the report rests on unnamed sources.

DIGITAL ADVOCACY AND RIGHTS ALLIANCE (DARA)

- **Ten CSOs Form Digital Rights Coalition** — Liberian Observer, 24 September 2026

  Ten Liberian civil society organisations signed a memorandum founding the Digital Advocacy and Rights Alliance. It commits them to press for an independent data protection authority, amendments narrowing the Cybercrime Act of 2025 and tighter oversight of state interception, and court authorisation for internet shutdowns. A founding assembly is due within 90 days; the signing date is not given.

- **Liberia: Ten Liberian Civil Society Groups Launch Digital Advocacy and Rights Alliance** — FrontPage Africa, 25 September 2026

  Ten Liberian civil society organisations, including CENTAL and the Liberia Equality Network, signed a memorandum establishing the Digital Advocacy and Rights Alliance (DARA). The coalition is to work on digital rights, privacy, online safety and digital freedoms.

ICT Infrastructure

Cybersecurity

Cybersecurity

CYBERCRIME ACT 2025

- **Liberia's Free-Speech Balancing Act and What the Cybercrime Law Actually Changed** — FrontPageAfrica, 11 September 2026

  A FrontPageAfrica commentary compares Liberia's Cybercrime Act of 2025, whose printed text is marked approved on 3 July 2026, with the 2019 Kamara Abdullah Kamara Act that decriminalised sedition and criminal libel of the President. It sets out the Act's speech-related offences, including cyberstalking and harmful data messages, and a judge-ordered interception power. It also notes a pending amendment, introduced in March 2026, to criminalise insulting language online.

- **Liberia's New Cybercrime Law: The New Digital Police Power and the Fight Over Free Speech** — Smart News Liberia, 19 September 2026

Liberia's Cybercrime Act of 2025 has been published as approved law, and its first public test is a warning by the Executive Protection Service director, Sam Gaye, that makers of manipulated material meant to insult or harass could be prosecuted. It followed an arrest over a doctored video of Vice-President Jeremiah Kpan Koung. The article weighs this against the constitution's free-expression guarantee.

- **Koung Seeks Release of AI Image Suspect** — The New Dawn Liberia, 21 September 2026

  Liberia's vice-president Jeremiah Koung asked for the release of Jerry Nyantee Wrotto, whom police detained under the Cybercrime Act over AI-made images and videos of Koung, and said he would not press charges. It is one of the first high-profile uses of the Act, signed on 19 August 2026 with the Data Protection Act. The head of the Executive Protection Service defended the arrest, while critics including former finance minister Samuel Tweah said the Act's cyberbullying clauses cover protected speech.

- **Liberia's Cybercrime Law Faces Its First Real Trial as VP Koung case exposes Liberia's widening fault lines** — FrontPage Africa, 21 September 2026

  A second account of the Wrotto arrest, summarised under the New Dawn report. It adds a justice ministry prosecutor's view that the state, not the vice-president, decides whether a prosecution goes ahead, and notes that the Act does not mention AI or deepfakes.

- **Liberia: CDC Prepares to Take Cybercrime Law Fight to Supreme Court After Wrato Release** — FrontPage Africa, 23 September 2026

  Liberia's opposition CDC says it will ask the Supreme Court to rule on the constitutionality of the Cybercrime Act of 2025. The move follows the court-ordered release on 22 September of commentator Jerry Nyantee Wrato, whom police intended to prosecute under the Act over AI-generated images of the Vice President.

- **Liberia: Judge Gives Police 'Last Opportunity' in Cybercrime Suspect's Detention Case** — FrontPage Africa, 25 September 2026

  A Monrovia criminal court gave the police a last opportunity to justify holding Jerry Nyantee Wrato, a suspect under the Cybercrime Act, after no officer appeared for the second time. The judge found the state had not shown the case was lawfully before the court and postponed the habeas corpus hearing to 25 September.

DPI

Data Exchange · Digital Identity and CRVS · Digital Payments and Fintech · Registries · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

Data Exchange

EDUCATION MANAGEMENT INFORMATION SYSTEM (EMIS 2.0)

- **MOE Pushes for Real-Time School Data System** — Liberian Observer, 30 September 2026

  Liberia's Ministry of Education held a consultation on 28 and 29 September 2026, with the African Union and UNICEF, to draft an Education Management Information System policy. The ministry wants schools to feed real-time data on student and teacher attendance to a central dashboard. An AU peer review had found fragmented data collection and inconsistent standards.

Digital Identity and CRVS

NATIONAL IDENTIFICATION SYSTEM CONCESSION

- **Liberia: NIR: US$54.7M Digital ID Deal Awaits Legislative Approval** — FrontPage Africa, 8 September 2026

Liberia's US$54.7 million concession with Austria's OeSD International to rebuild the national identification system has been signed but cannot be implemented until the legislature ratifies it, National Identification Registry director Andrew Peters said. The project covers biometric enrolment and deduplication, digital and physical credentials and a digital identity platform. No signature date is given.

- **Liberia to link national ID, CRVS in planned infrastructure upgrade** — Biometric Update, 14 September 2026

  Liberia's identification registry plans one system linking national ID with civil registration and vital statistics under its proposed US$54 million partnership with Austria's OSD. The signed agreement still needs parliamentary approval, and ID issuance has been suspended since June 2025.

- **Liberia: Free National ID Cards Only for Disadvantaged Liberians - Says National Identification Registry** — allAfrica.com, 17 September 2026

  Liberia's National Identification Registry said on 15 September 2026 that free national ID cards will go only to disadvantaged and unemployed citizens, with employed Liberians and foreign residents paying a fee. It is seeking about US$54.7m for the programme, which starts once an agreement before the legislature is ratified. Its director said the financier, OSD, will invest in ICT infrastructure while the registry keeps custody of personal data.

- **NIR Seeks Legislative Approval for US$54.7M Identity Deal - Liberia news The New Dawn Liberia, premier resource for latest news** — Liberia news The New Dawn Liberia, premier resource for latest news, 17 September 2026

  Liberia's National Identification Registry asked the legislature on 16 September 2026 to speed ratification of a US$54.7 million identity deal with OeSD International. Under the build, operate and transfer arrangement OeSD would fund biometric enrolment and infrastructure, run it to recover the investment, then hand it to government. No signature date is given.

NATIONAL IDENTITY ENROLMENT

- **Liberia: President Boakai Declares Wednesday, September 16, as "National Identification Day** — APO Group - Africa Newsroom, 16 September 2026

  Liberia's President Joseph Nyuma Boakai declared 16 September 2026 National Identification Day, a working holiday, by proclamation. The proclamation states that about 720,000 people are enrolled in the National Biometric Identification System, run by the National Identification Registry set up by law in 2011, and that every person in Liberia is required to enrol.

Digital Payments and Fintech

NATIONAL ELECTRONIC PAYMENT SWITCH

- **Finance Minister Highlights Economic Growth, Revenue Mobilization, Infrastructure, Digital Payments and Diaspora Capital at Washington Conference** — Cape 96.5 FM/TV, 26 September 2026

  Liberia's Finance Minister Augustine Kpehe Ngafuan told a diaspora conference in Washington that the Inclusive Instant Payment System, launched by the Central Bank of Liberia in December 2025, processed more than 1.5 million transactions worth over L$1.4 billion and US$9 million in its first three months. It first linked the Lonestar MTN and Orange mobile-money platforms. A national electronic payment switch is the longer-term aim.

- **Bet on Liberia** — The New Dawn Liberia, 28 September 2026

Liberia's finance minister told the diaspora conference near Washington that the national electronic payment switch is targeted for March 2027, alongside the central bank's inclusive instant payment system.

DIGIGOV LIBERIA GOVERNMENT PAYMENTS (P2G AND G2P) DIGITISATION PROJECT

- **Multinational - Government Payments (P2G & G2P) Digitization in Mano River Union - Liberia - Project Completion Report** — African Development Bank Group, 27 September 2026

  The African Development Bank published on 27 September 2026 the completion report for DIGIGOV Liberia, part of its project to digitise government payments in the Mano River Union. The project aimed to set up an e-payment system hosted by the Liberia Revenue Authority for customs tax collection, build local digital finance capacity and run consumer-protection work. The summary page gives no results or figures.

PAY NA-NA INCLUSIVE INSTANT PAYMENT SYSTEM

- **Liberia's Instant Payment System Crosses 5.3M Transactions** — Liberian Observer, 1 October 2026

  Liberia's instant payment system has processed more than 5.3 million transactions between the two mobile money operators since its December 2025 launch, the central bank governor said. About 4.2 million were in Liberian dollars and 1.1 million in US dollars.

Registries

ENHANCED COLLATERAL REGISTRY

- **Liberia: Financial Inclusion Must Not Become Debt Inclusion** — allAfrica.com (Liberian Observer), 1 September 2026

  A Liberian Observer editorial argues that Liberia's newly launched Enhanced Collateral Registry, which lets borrowers pledge inventory, equipment and livestock, needs clear loan terms and real-time credit reporting alongside it. It cites a non-performing loan ratio of 19.1 per cent in 2024 and 12.9 per cent in 2025, ahead of a national conference on bad loans on 9–11 September.

COLLATERAL REGISTRY

- **Liberia's New Collateral Registry Opens Credit Doors for SMEs, Tightens Lending Controls** — FrontPageAfrica, 4 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Liberia said registration in its enhanced collateral registry is now mandatory for financial institutions, at a training for about 35 loan and credit officers. The registry covers movable and immovable assets, allows remote public searches for prior liens, and is designed to link to the national ID registry, the land registry and the traffic system.

PRIVATE CREDIT REFERENCE BUREAU LICENSING UNDER REGULATION CBL/SD/003/2010

- **Liberia: Prime Credit Sues Central Bank, Demands Nearly US$1.2M Over Credit Bureau Dispute** — FrontPage Africa, 16 September 2026

  Prime Credit Reference Bureau is suing the Central Bank of Liberia for US$1,180,953, alleging the bank never supplied or ordered lenders to supply the loan data its November 2025 licence depended on. It says the bank later wrote that it lacked clear authority to license private bureaux; the claims are untested.

Sectoral management information systems

ONEHEALTHEHR OFFLINE-FIRST HEALTH RECORD AND SURVEILLANCE PLATFORM

- **OneHealthEHR Goes Live in Liberia, Ghana** — Liberian Observer, 28 September 2026 GHANA

OneHealthEHR's offline-first health record and disease-surveillance platform went into clinical use in Liberia and Ghana on 1 September, growing from four to seven facilities in three weeks by the company's account. It targets 30-40 clinics by December, with Liberia's public health institute as its surveillance partner.

GENDER-BASED VIOLENCE INFORMATION MANAGEMENT SYSTEM (GBVIMS)

- **Gov't Launches Upgraded GBV Information System to Strengthen Survivor Services** — Liberian Observer, 14 October 2026

  Liberia's Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection launched an upgraded Gender-Based Violence Information Management System with UNFPA support under the EU-backed Spotlight Initiative 2.0. It covers incident reporting, survivor case management and referrals; UNFPA handed over 40 tablets, a server and four laptops.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

ISOFT PUBLIC SECTOR INTERNAL AUDIT MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **IAA Goes Digital** — The New Dawn Liberia, 9 September 2026

  Liberia's Internal Audit Agency was due to launch its own custom software for planning, running and tracking internal audits across government on 10 September 2026 at Monrovia City Hall, Information Minister Jerolinmek Matthew Piah announced. It is the agency's first in-house digital system. No cost is given.

- **IAA Launches Digital System to Strengthen Public Sector Audits** — Liberian Observer, 11 September 2026

  Liberia's Internal Audit Agency launched the iSoft Public Sector Internal Audit Management System in Monrovia, reported on 11 September 2026. Director General David Kermah said it replaces paper-based auditing and lets auditors plan audits, track findings and management responses, and produce reports from a central dashboard. No cost is given.

- **Liberia: IAA Launches Digital Platform To Improve Audit Processes** — FrontPageAfrica, 11 September 2026

  Liberia's Internal Audit Agency launched iSoft, a public-sector audit management system, in Monrovia on 10 September 2026 to replace paper-based audits. Director General David Kemah said auditors can plan audits, track findings and management responses, and produce real-time reports, with an audit trail for every government institution. No cost or supplier is given.

GENERAL AUDITING COMMISSION AUDIT AUTOMATION SYSTEM

- **GAC Automates Public Audits** — The New Dawn Liberia, 23 September 2026

  Liberia's General Auditing Commission has begun automating public-sector audits, with KPMG contracted to build audit software under a World Bank-supported project, deputy information minister Daniel Sanoe said at a press briefing on 22 September 2026. No contract value or timetable is given.

ONLINE POLICE CLEARANCE PLATFORM

- **Police Online Clearance Generates US$200K** — The New Dawn Liberia, 8 October 2026

  Liberia's online police clearance system has generated more than US$200,000 since May 2026, the deputy information minister said. No figure for the manual system it replaced was given.

Technology

Innovation ecosystem

Innovation ecosystem

COUNTY DIGITAL HUBS

- **Liberia: AYEE Summit Opens in Monrovia, Elevate Liberia Program Launched** — FrontPage Africa, 11 September 2026

  Liberia Telecommunications Authority chairman Clarence Massaquoi told the AYEE youth summit in Monrovia on 11 September 2026 that the regulator has an agreement with the youth and sports ministry to set up 15 digital hubs, one per county, backed by more than US$200,000. He also announced a partnership with the education ministry to connect 156 public high schools to high-speed internet.

Capacity

Training and skills

Training and skills

UNIVERSITY ONLINE-TUITION AND SMART-CLASSROOM PARTNERSHIP

- **UL Signs Tripartite Partnership** — Liberian Observer, 7 September 2026

  A tripartite memorandum signed on 27 August has a foreign online university covering 97% of online tuition for more than 200 students of the national university, with three smart classrooms due in 2027. No commitment amount is stated.

UNIVERSITY OF LIBERIA MASTER'S PROGRAMME IN ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

- **Building Liberia's AI Future - UNDP, UL Consult Stakeholders** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), 9 September 2026

  The University of Liberia, with UNDP support, is running national stakeholder consultations on establishing Liberia's first MSc in Artificial Intelligence, bringing together government institutions, development partners, academia, private-sector actors and civil society.

LIBERIA WOMEN'S DIGITAL AND ECONOMIC EMPOWERMENT PROGRAM

- **Gender Minister Signs Partnership with Cybastion Institute of Technology and Cisco System** — Liberia Broadcasting System (LBS), 23 September 2026

  Liberia's gender minister Gbeme Horace-Kollie signed a partnership with Cybastion Institute of Technology and Cisco Systems in New York on 22 September 2026 to build digital skills among women. Cybastion is to build, equip and run five technology and business hubs for women in Lofa, Margibi, Grand Bassa, Bong and Montserrado counties over 36 months. No cost is given.

- **Liberia and Cybastion Partner to Launch Women's Digital and Business Innovation Hubs** — Tech Africa News, 23 September 2026

  Liberia's gender ministry signed an agreement with Cybastion, on the sidelines of the UN General Assembly, for women's technology and business hubs with childcare: a Monrovia campus and regional sites in Voinjama, Gbarnga, Kakata and Buchanan. Training is to run through Cisco's Networking Academy; no cost or timetable was given.

YAMA RUSSELL MODEL LAB (HELPING AFRICA FOUNDATION ICT LABORATORY)

- **10 Years of Impact: Helping Africa Foundation calls for nationwide expansion of Nyamransa ICT model** — ModernGhana, 23 September 2026 GHANA GAMBIA

> The US-based Helping Africa Foundation marked its tenth anniversary in Gbawe, Ghana, and called on African governments to expand its youth ICT laboratory model. It has supported more than 19 ICT demonstration labs in Ghana, The Gambia and Liberia, with more planned in Tanzania and Zanzibar. Ghana's education ministry will discuss a scale-up policy; no funding is stated.

Inclusion

Access to services

Access to services

> DECENTRALISED REGULATOR SERVICE CENTRES
>
> - **LTA Begins Decentralizing Its Regulatory And Consumer Protection Services** — News Public Trust, 5 September 2026
>
>   The Liberia Telecommunications Authority opened its first service centre outside Monrovia, in Buchanan, Grand Bassa County, on 4 September 2026, offering regulatory and consumer-protection services locally. Chairman Clarence Massaquoi said the centre will also help community radio stations with compliance and serve as a model for other counties.

> FREEDOM OF INFORMATION COMPLIANCE ENFORCEMENT DRIVE
>
> - **IIC, CENTAL Step Up Transparency, Anti-Corruption Drive** — Global News Network Liberia, 6 September 2026
>
>   Liberia's Independent Information Commission and the anti-corruption group CENTAL ran a Freedom of Information Act compliance campaign from 11 August to 2 September 2026 at the national identification registry, the statistics institute LISGIS, LACE and the water corporation. Agencies were told to appoint information officers, set up request review bodies and publish budgets and contracts proactively. Three more agencies were scheduled for 8-10 September.

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